

Emotions & Character

52 words · Emotions & Character

NOUNS

mood

a temporary state of mind or feeling

She's been in a really good mood all day.

empathy

the ability to understand and share another person's feelings

A good leader needs empathy as much as strategic thinking.

insecurity

a feeling of uncertainty or lack of confidence about oneself

His arrogance is really just insecurity in disguise.

temper

a person's tendency to become angry

He has a terrible temper. He shouts over the smallest things.

resilience

the ability to recover from setbacks or adversity

Her resilience after everything she's been through is remarkable.

an oddball

a person who behaves in an unusual or eccentric way

He's a bit of an oddball, but everyone loves him.

ADJECTIVES

grateful

feeling thankful for something received or experienced

I'm so grateful for everything you've done.

frustrated

feeling upset because you are unable to change or achieve something

He was frustrated by the lack of progress.

open-minded

willing to consider new ideas and different opinions

You need to be open-minded if you're going to travel alone.

narrow-minded

unwilling to listen to new ideas or accept that other people's opinions might be right

He can be a bit narrow-minded about anything outside his own experience.

thick-skinned

not easily hurt or offended by criticism

You need to be thick-skinned to work in politics.

anxious

feeling worried or uneasy about something uncertain

She felt anxious about the interview for days beforehand.

stubborn

refusing to change one's mind or course of action

She's incredibly stubborn. Once she's decided, there's no changing her mind.

cocky

too confident in yourself, often in an annoying way

cocky

moody

having unpredictable changes of mood, especially towards being irritable

He can be quite moody, fine one minute and snapping the next.

short-tempered

easily angered or irritated

She gets short-tempered when she's tired.

laid-back

calm, relaxed, and not easily worried

He's very laid-back. Nothing ever seems to bother him.

bubbly

happy and full of energy

She has such a bubbly personality, everyone warms to her instantly.

volatile

(of a person) liable to sudden and unpredictable changes in mood

He's volatile. You never know whether he'll laugh or explode.

flaky

unreliable and often cancelling plans at the last moment (informal)

Don't count on him. He's incredibly flaky.

stoic

enduring pain or difficulty without showing emotion or complaint

He remained stoic throughout the ordeal and never once complained.

PHRASAL VERBS

cheer up

to become happier or to make someone happier

She brought him flowers to cheer him up.

bottle up

to suppress emotions rather than expressing them

He tends to bottle up his feelings instead of talking about them.

wind up

to deliberately annoy or provoke someone

He loves winding his sister up. It's his favourite hobby.

open up

to begin to share personal feelings or thoughts

It took him a long time to open up about what had happened.

calm down

to become less angry, upset, or excited

He needed a few minutes to calm down after the argument.

lose touch with

to gradually stop communicating with someone, especially an old friend

We were inseparable at university, but we lost touch with each other after graduation.

lash out

to suddenly attack someone verbally or physically, often through anger

She lashed out at her colleague during the meeting.

reach out

to make an effort to contact someone, especially to offer or ask for help

If you're ever struggling, please reach out. Don't just deal with it on your own.

COLLOCATIONS

lose your temper

to suddenly become very angry

She lost her temper and shouted at the whole team.

make up her mind

to decide firmly

Always. Once she's made up her mind, there's no changing it.

a people person

someone who is naturally sociable and enjoys being around others

She's such a people person that she'll happily chat to anyone at a party.

on edge

nervous, tense, or easily startled

He'd been on edge all week waiting for the test results.

IDIOMS

keep your cool

to stay calm in a difficult or stressful situation

She kept her cool even when the client started shouting.

put on a brave face

to pretend to be happy or confident when you are not

She put on a brave face but inside she was devastated.

wear your heart on your sleeve

to show your emotions openly rather than hiding them

She's never been able to hide how she feels. She wears her heart on her sleeve.

out of sorts

slightly unwell or in a bad mood

A bit out of sorts, to be honest. I didn't sleep well.

a heart of gold

a very kind, generous nature

I know. But he's got a heart of gold underneath all that.

a chip on your shoulder

a deep-seated resentment or sense of grievance

He's had a chip on his shoulder ever since he was passed over for promotion.

have a soft spot for

to feel a particular fondness or affection for someone or something, often without a clear reason

Grandad always had a soft spot for the youngest grandchild, even though he insisted he didn't have favourites.

get something off your chest

to tell someone about something that has been worrying or upsetting you for a while, so you feel better

You should tell her, it'll help to get it off your chest.

over the moon

extremely happy and excited

She was over the moon when she got the job offer.

have a heart of gold

to be a very kind and generous person despite appearances

He looks tough, but he's got a heart of gold.

get on someone's nerves

to irritate or annoy someone

His constant humming really gets on my nerves.

a bundle of nerves

a person who is extremely anxious

I was a bundle of nerves. My hands were shaking.

swallow your pride

to do something even though it hurts your dignity

He swallowed his pride and apologised, even though he felt he was right.

a leopard can't change its spots

used to say that a person's basic character never really changes

He keeps promising to be more patient, but a leopard can't change its spots.

let off steam

to release energy or strong feelings, usually anger or frustration, by doing something active or loud

He goes for a run after work to let off steam.

SET PHRASES

I'm here if you need to talk

used to offer emotional support without pressuring someone to open up

I'm here if you need to talk, whenever you're ready. No pressure.

MODERN SLANG

salty

feeling bitter or resentful about something, often unfairly

He's still salty about not getting invited to the party.

me time

time spent alone doing something purely for your own relaxation or enjoyment

Between the kids and work, I barely get any me time these days.

vibe

the general mood or atmosphere of a person, place, or situation

The restaurant had a really good vibe, very relaxed.